6.6.4e Emphasis in Colour

It can be achieved by contrast of hue, light and dark and brightness, the effect of every other colour used. In the arrangement, the emphasizing colour should be subordinated to the main colour to prevent confusion.

6.6.5 Balance

Balance in design is so natural that one is not even aware of it when it is present, but when it is violated there is a sense of discomfort or annoyance. (Figure 6.34).

6.6.5a Formal balance

If objects are alike or are equally forceful in appearance they will attract the same amount of attention, therefore should be equidistant from the centre.

6.6.5b Informal balance

If, however, objects do not attract the same amount of attention, they must be placed at different distances from the centre. This second type of balance is called informal, or occult, or asymmetric balance. Informal balance is more subtle than formal balance and affords greater opportunity for variety in arrangements. Its success depends upon training the eye to recognize a restful composition.

Whether one uses formal or informal balance depends largely upon the following conditions.

1. The spirit of the age in which one lives
2. The use to which the garment is to be put
3. The type of people for whom the dress is planned
4. One's own personality

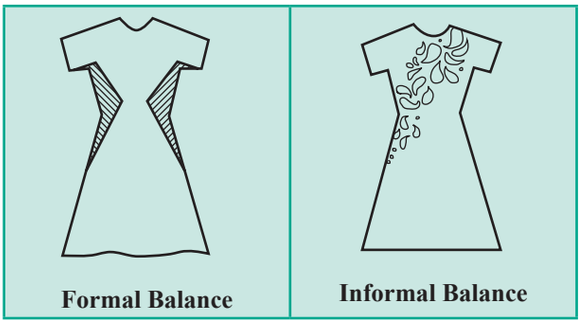


Figure 6.34 Balance

Balance in Colour

Balance or the feeling of rest underlines the well known "Law of Areas". The law of areas is also known as "The law of backgrounds". This law states large areas of colour should be quite in effect, while small amounts may show strong contrast; the larger the areas quieter the colour and smaller the area the more striking the contrasts may become. This contrast may be done due to a decided difference in hue, in value or in intensity.

A small quantity of light value will balance a large amount of a dark value or small amounts of dark can balance large areas of light.

The hues which are directly opposite to each other in the chart form a natural balance because they complement each other in the eye. Balance of colours can also be achieved by selecting the varied amounts of bright and dull colours and by arrangement of these colours. By repeating some of the colours, colours or values can be balanced, in various parts of an arrangement this is also called a 'crossing' which has tendency to give a feeling of rest.

6.7 Summary

These elements of design are arranged as per the principles of design to obtain a perfect

XII TDD_English version CHAPTER 06.indd 96 1/13/2020 3:08:42 PM